

SERVING PLAN 3 SERVING PLAN

# Greek Lamb Meatballs

## with Feta Rice and Lemon-Tomato Sauce

Tonight's repeat favorite meal highlights the ultimate balance of Greek flavors: fresh herbs, salty feta cheese, and super-savory meats. If you're big on lemon, we've suggested two uses: a little zest to add aromatic flavor to the lamb and beef meatballs, and a squeeze of tart juice to brighten the homemade tomato sauce infused with oregano.

35–45 minutes  860 calories per serving

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## Ingredients

- 1 cup basmati rice
- 1 lemon, divided
- 1 herb mix
  - ⅛ ounce dill
  - ⅛ ounce parsley, divided
  - ⅛ ounce oregano
- 1 packet Kalamata olives
- 1 red onion
- 3 cloves garlic, divided
- ⅓ cup panko breadcrumbs
- 15 ounces ground beef and lamb
- ¼ teaspoon crushed red pepper
- ¼ cup red wine
- 1 can diced tomatoes
- 1 ounce feta cheese, divided

## You'll need

- olive oil
- 1 egg
- black pepper
- kosher salt
- 6" small pot with lid
- 12" large pan

## Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking. Trust us—you'll be glad you did!

The skin of the lemon (and other citrus fruits) is home to the highest concentration of aromatic oils, so chefs use zest to add bright, perfumy flavor and a little texture. It's easier and safer to zest the lemon before cutting and juicing. If you don't love citrus flavor, feel free to skip it.

USDA recommends cooking ground beef and lamb to 160°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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## 1. Cook rice

In a small pot, combine **rice**, **1½ cups water**, and **¼ teaspoon salt**, and bring to a boil over high heat. Reduce heat to medium low, cover pot, and simmer until water is fully absorbed, 10–12 minutes. Remove pot from heat and let stand, still covered, until Step 6.



## 2. Prepare ingredients

While rice cooks, rinse all produce. If you have a zester on hand and want to infuse your meatballs with even more lemon flavor, zest **up to ½ lemon** (see recipe tip). Then, halve **lemon**. Roughly chop **dill** leaves and finely chop **parsley** leaves, keeping separate and discarding stems. Set aside **whole oregano sprigs** for Step 5. Roughly chop **olives**. Peel **onion**, halve, and thinly slice. Mince **garlic**.



## 3. Form and sear meatballs

In a large bowl, combine **breadcrumbs**, **lemon zest** (if using), **half of parsley**, **half of garlic**, **1 egg**, **¾ teaspoon salt**, and **black pepper**. Pat **beef and lamb** dry and add to bowl. Using your hands, mix well, then form into 15 equal balls, 2 inches thick (this is a great task for a kitchen helper). Heat **1½ tablespoons olive oil** in a large pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **meatballs**. Sear, flipping, until browned on all sides, 10 minutes total.



## 4. Sauté aromatics

Once cooked, transfer **meatballs** to a plate and set aside. Return pan from meatballs to medium-high heat and add **onion**. Cook, scraping up browned bits from bottom of pan, until onion has softened, about 3 minutes. Add **crushed red pepper** (skip or use half for less heat) and **remaining garlic**, and sauté, stirring, until fragrant, 1 minute more.



## 5. Make tomato-lemon sauce

Add **wine** to pan with aromatics, still over medium-high heat, and cook until liquid is reduced by half, about 1 minute. Add **diced tomatoes and their juices** and **whole oregano sprigs**, and simmer until sauce has thickened, about 6 minutes more. Remove and discard **oregano**. Add **meatballs**, stir to coat with sauce, and turn to warm through, 1–2 minutes. Remove pan from heat. Stir in **juice of ½ lemon**, **½ teaspoon salt**, and **black pepper**.



## 6. Plate Greek lamb meatballs

Fluff cooked **rice** with a fork, then add **dill**, **half of feta**, **juice of remaining lemon** (or use less, as desired), and **1 tablespoon olive oil** to pot and stir to combine. Serve **Greek lamb meatballs** with **feta rice**, and spoon over **tomato-lemon sauce**. Garnish with **olives**, **remaining parsley**, and **remaining feta**, and dig in!

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